

Apply for a Science Corps Fellowship - Entry #3309

Name

Briana Sealey

Emailbrianasealey@gmail.com**Gender**

Female

City, state, and country of residence

Austin

Nationality

United States citizen

When did or will you finish your PhD?

finished May 11, 2024

University Education

Ph.D. Ecology, Evolution and Behavior, The University of Texas at Austin (UT Austin)

M.S. Ecology and Evolutionary Biology, University of Michigan, Ann Arbor (UM)

B.A. Biology, Case Western Reserve University (CWRU)

What are your reasons for applying to be a Science Corps fellow?

I am applying to be a Science Corps fellow because I believe in the transformative power of education, particularly in underrepresented regions where access to quality STEM learning is limited. It is important to share scientific knowledge and contribute to global education and I want to be a part of a team that centers these values. As a wildlife biologist with research and teaching experience, I want to use my skills to inspire students and promote scientific literacy.

The opportunity to engage with diverse communities and work hands-on in education aligns with my long-term goal of making science more accessible and fostering global collaboration. Science Corps offers a unique chance to not only teach but also empower future generations by creating lasting educational resources. Additionally, this fellowship will allow me to grow as an educator and mentor, gaining valuable cross-cultural experiences while contributing meaningfully to local communities.

I am excited to engage in a program that aligns so closely with my interest in science education and outreach.

In addition to your studies, describe any relevant experiences that have prepared you for a Science Corps fellowship.

In addition to my academic studies, I have gained valuable experience through my most recent roles as a research fellow, graduate teaching assistant and adjunct instructor, all of which have prepared me for the Science Corps fellowship. As a research fellow at the Smithsonian Tropical Research Institute, I led an international wildlife field project for two years. This hands-on experience enhanced my ability to design, implement, and communicate scientific research to diverse audiences and challenging environments.

As a graduate teaching assistant and adjunct instructor, I developed teaching skills by delivering complex scientific concepts to students with varying levels of knowledge. I would often incorporate artwork and diagrams to facilitate learning and understanding. These roles strengthened my commitment to making science more accessible and inspiring curiosity in my students.

Furthermore, my outreach efforts, including leading science workshops for underserved communities in Panama and throughout the United States, have demonstrated the critical role clear communication plays in promoting scientific understanding and sparking enthusiasm. These experiences have equipped me to effectively teach and engage students from diverse backgrounds, and has helped prepare me for this kind of position to inspire future scholars worldwide through Science Corps.

Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply.

Academic scientist in academia

In science education

In science outreach

Other

Expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally in the near (two year) and long-term (ten year) future.

In two years, I see myself as a postdoctoral researcher, integrating both research and outreach in my work. I aim to contribute to novel scientific discoveries while actively engaging with the broader community to promote science education. By combining my research with outreach efforts, I hope

to inspire the next generation of scientists and increase public understanding of important scientific issues.

In ten years, I see myself as either an academic scientist or a wildlife biologist working within the government, continuing my dedication to advance research in my field. I also aim to continue to prioritize outreach work, using my platform to engage with the public and inspire future scientists. Whether in academia or a government role, I am committed to contributing to wildlife education and ensuring that science is accessible to broad audiences.

CV/Resume

 [2024-09-04-Briana-Sealey-Science-Corp-CV.pdf](#)

How did you find out about Science Corps?

A friend or colleague

Any other comments/questions?

Thank you for this opportunity!

[Science Corps](#)